

# Riseguide vs. Liven · Coursiv Headway

A side-by-side reputation benchmark across product quality, customer service, user feedback, billing transparency and brand trust · May 29, 2026

RISEGUIDE COMPOSITE

5.4<sub>/10</sub>

▲ +0.2

Mixed

#3 of 4 · Headway leads at 6.1

BIGGEST WIN THIS WEEK

Sentiment & platform consistency 6.0/10 · ▲ +1.0

COHORT COMPOSITE SCORES

RiseGuide

5.4<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.4 / 5 · Trustpilot  
17,950+ reviews

Liven

5.0<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.5 / 5 · Apple App Store  
49K iOS ratings

Coursiv

5.6<sub>/10</sub>

Mixed

4.5 / 5 · Trustpilot  
119,000+ reviews

Headway

6.1<sub>/10</sub>

Watch

4.6 / 5 · Apple App Store  
115K iOS ratings

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY · ALL DIMENSIONS

|           |                          | RISEGUIDE                                      | LIVEN                                          | COURSIV                                        | HEADWAY                                        |
|-----------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 01        | Product Quality          | <div><div></div></div> 7.0                     | <div><div></div></div> 5.7                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.7                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.2                     |
| 02        | Customer Service         | <div><div></div></div> 5.6                     | <div><div></div></div> 4.0                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.3                     | <div><div></div></div> 5.2                     |
| 03        | User Feedback            | <div><div></div></div> 6.5                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.1                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.4                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.1                     |
| 04        | Billing Transparency     | <div><div></div></div> 3.6                     | <div><div></div></div> 2.9                     | <div><div></div></div> 3.1                     | <div><div></div></div> 3.9                     |
| 05        | Brand Trust & Legitimacy | <div><div></div></div> 4.4                     | <div><div></div></div> 6.4                     | <div><div></div></div> 4.6                     | <div><div></div></div> 7.1                     |
| COMPOSITE |                          | <div>5.4<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▲ +0.2</div> | <div>5.0<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▼ -0.6</div> | <div>5.6<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▼ -0.2</div> | <div>6.1<sub>/10</sub></div> <div>▼ -0.6</div> |

01

Product Quality

7.0/10

▲ +0.3

Headway leads this dimension at 7.2/10; RiseGuide sits at 7.0/10 (was 6.7 last week). Liven regressed most this week (-0.6 vs. last week).

RiseGuide 7.0 ▲ +0.3

Liven 5.7 ▼ -0.6

Coursiv 6.7

Headway 7.2 ▼ -0.5

Marketing vs reality

RISEGUIDE

Watch · 6.3

▲ +0.3

The bite-sized promise keeps holding up where it matters — execution complaints faded this week. Bug-tagged reviews shifted from 100% negative to mostly resolved (8 App Store mentions averaging 3.6 stars, up from 1.0 last week). The one fresh negative signal is creative-side: a Reddit post calling the 'Speak Up Confidently' YouTube ad 'extremely annoying' with 'terrible tone' — a marketing tone complaint, not a product one.

LIVEN

Mixed · 5

▼ -1.0

**A new wave of iOS bug complaints emerged — a complaint category that wasn't visible last week.**

Trustpilot still rewards the CBT wellness positioning, but app-store sentiment is slipping. Bug and slow-performance complaints are increasingly visible — marketed promise diverging from daily-use experience.

COURSIV

Mixed · 5.5

▲ +0.5

**Product-experience sentiment rose sharply — beginner-AI lessons earned the cohort's most concentrated positive cluster.**

Beginner-AI lessons land strongly with first-time users — earned the cohort's most concentrated positive cluster. Drag remains deceptive-advertising and pricing complaints from outside the funnel.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 7

Book-summary promise delivered consistently across both stores. Sentiment is net-positive and stable, no new complaint cluster, and YouTube creator coverage is unanimously positive.

Unique value proposition

RISEGUIDE

Healthy · 7.3

▲ +0.3

The structured Journey format keeps doing the heavy lifting — 63 App Store reviews this week tagged 'Satisfied users' averaging 4.9 stars, and 14 reviews specifically praising 'Complexity' (meaning low complexity) at 4.8 stars. Use-case reviews land at 4.4 stars across 12 App Store mentions. No competitor or alternative format gets the same density of unprompted praise anywhere in the dataset.

LIVEN

Watch · 6.5

▼ -0.5

**Sentiment on the AI companion (Liven's flagship differentiator) is now visibly split — the core moat is weakening.**  
The CBT-companion + mood tracker stack is coherent on paper, but reviewers split on whether the AI companion helps or distracts. The differentiator isn't fully landing.

COURSIV

Healthy · 7.5

▲ +0.5

**Beginner-AI positioning is increasingly validated — Coursiv earned the cohort's strongest single product-feature endorsement.**  
Mobile-first AI skill tracks remain clearly differentiated from desktop video-course competitors. Product experience earned the cohort's most concentrated positive sentiment.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Category leader by every measure: scale, feature maturity, review-base depth. No meaningful movement on the differentiation story.

Accessibility & consistency

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
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| <div><div>RISEGUIDE</div><div>LEADER</div></div> <div>Healthy · 7.3</div> <div>▲ +0.3</div> <div><p>Up from last week. Last week's performance complaint cluster turned out to be a one-cycle blip, not a regression. The App Store performance topic dropped from 12 mentions to 7 this week and the average rating attached to it climbed from 2.8 to 3.0. Whatever caused the spike has resolved on its own — no sprint intervention required.</p><p>Last week's performance scare was a one-cycle blip, not a regression. App Store performance complaints dropped from 12 mentions to 7 this week, and the average rating attached to that topic climbed from 2.8 to 3.0. Either the underlying transient (load spike or temporary build issue) cleared on its own, or the team caught it quietly. Cross-platform ratings remain stable: Trustpilot 4.4, App Store 4.6, Google Play 4.2.</p></div> | <div>LIVEN</div> <div>Mixed · 5.5</div> <div>▼ -0.5</div> <div><p>The iOS bug-complaint cluster expanded — now the broadest in cohort relative to volume.</p><p>Aggregate ratings are decent, but the iOS bug cluster is the broadest in cohort relative to volume. ADHD/anxiety customisation gaps remain active.</p></div> | <div>COURSIV</div> <div>Healthy · 7</div> <div>▼ -1.0</div> <div><p>Score softened because we don't have Coursiv iOS in tracking — visibility gap, not product regression.</p><p>Google Play sentiment is overwhelmingly positive. We don't have visibility into iOS reviews because that app isn't in our tracking tool — this rating reflects Android only.</p></div> | <div>HEADWAY</div> <div>Watch · 6.5</div> <div>▼ -1.5</div> <div><p>Product still stable; experience around it slipped. Support team has stopped replying to iOS reviews entirely.</p><p>Aggregate ratings remain strong with a small iOS-Android gap. Structural concern: the support team has stopped replying to iOS reviews entirely. Product consistent; experience around it isn't.</p></div> |
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02

Customer Service

5.6/10

▲ +0.3

Coursiv leads this dimension at **6.3/10**; RiseGuide sits at **5.6/10** (was 5.3 last week).  
Headway regressed most this week (-1.1 vs. last week).

RiseGuide 5.6 ▲ +0.3

Liven 4.0 ▼ -1.0

Coursiv 6.3 ▼ -0.4

Headway 5.2 ▼ -1.1

Support channel availability

RISEGUIDE

LEADER

Watch · 6

Coverage is unchanged: email and the help portal carry everything, no live chat or phone tier. The exceptional reply density is happening through manual operations, not tooling — which means the constraint isn't channels, it's how much further the team can scale this approach before throughput becomes the bottleneck.

LIVEN

Mixed · 4.5

▼ -1.5

The iOS support channel went structurally silent — zero replies on 100 sampled iOS reviews while Android stayed strong.

Critical structural gap: the team engages actively on Android but doesn't reply to iOS reviews at all. The 'multi-channel support' claim doesn't hold on the largest store.

COURSIV

LEADER

Watch · 6

Score softened because Coursiv iOS isn't in our tracking subscription — visibility gap, not support regression.

Multi-tier support (email, portal, knowledge base) plus active engagement on visible channels. Less visibility on iOS — that app isn't in our tracking tool.

HEADWAY

Mixed · 5.5

▼ -1.5

Same iOS reply gap as Liven became visible. Trustpilot's high reply rate had been masking it.

Same iOS gap as Liven, newly visible: replies on Android but not iOS. Trustpilot's high reply rate was masking it — once Appbot iOS was added, the dead-zone surfaced.

## Response speed & quality

### RISEGUIDE

LEADER

Watch · 6.5

▲ +0.5

Up from last week. Support sentiment is the best-improved App Store theme this week — Customer Support tagged reviews climbed to 4.0 stars across 14 mentions (up from 3.5 last week). 10 of 14 were tagged positive. Reviewers are now naming the support team specifically as the reason they're staying.

Support sentiment is the best-improved theme on the App Store this week — Customer Support tagged reviews climbed to 4.0 stars across 14 mentions, up from 3.5 last week. 10 of 14 were positive, and reviewers are now naming the support team specifically as why they're staying. The reply quality work the team has been doing is starting to land in the data.

### LIVEN

Mixed · 4

▼ -1.0

iOS support dead-zone is now confirmed as structural — zero replies for the second source of measurement.

Two-track operation: Android reviewers get steady engagement, iOS reviewers get nothing. Multi-week silence pattern reported by users is now confirmed as structural for iOS.

### COURSIV

LEADER

Watch · 6.5

▼ -0.5

Same visibility caveat — the read is incomplete on the iOS side, not declining.

Where visible, response density is excellent — every Android reviewer gets a reply, including every negative one. iOS visibility gap caps the read at watch-level.

### HEADWAY

Mixed · 5.5

▼ -1.5

Largest single regression in the benchmark. Appbot exposed an iOS reply gap that Trustpilot's 98% rate was hiding.

Same dual-track problem as Liven, exposed for the first time: Android engagement is total, iOS engagement is zero. Previous high score was Trustpilot-only signal.

# Complaint resolution rate

## RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 4.3

▲ +0.3

Down from last week. First reply miss in our tracking — one negative App Store review this week did not get a company response, breaking the 100% streak. Small in absolute terms (1 of 11 negatives unanswered), but the streak itself was the structural credibility. Worth investigating whether it's a missed handoff or a deliberate skip.

The 100% reply-to-negative streak broke on App Store this week — 1 of 11 negative reviews went without a company response (90.9%). Google Play actually moved the other direction, climbing to 100% (4 of 4 negatives replied). The structural concern persists: reply doesn't equal resolution, and BBB's historical 15% formal-resolution rate still tells a different story.

## LIVEN

Critical · 3.5

▼ -0.5

Negative iOS reviews now accumulate without response — refund and bug threads are structurally unanswered.

90% Trustpilot reply to negatives + Android Appbot strong, but iOS reviews accumulate without any response. Refund and bug threads on the largest store are structurally unanswered.

## COURSIV

LEADER

Watch · 6.5

▲ +0.5

Engagement velocity on visible channels stayed strong — every negative review got a reply.

100% reply to negative reviews on Trustpilot, but only 63.5% reply rate overall. Selective engagement — they answer negatives when they see them but skip a third of all reviews.

## HEADWAY

Mixed · 4.5

▼ -0.5

Same iOS dead-zone pattern: every negative iOS review is now ignored.

90% Trustpilot reply to negatives + 100% Android engagement, but iOS shows the same gap as response-speed: every negative iOS review is now ignored. Apple Communities refund-refusal threads remain active.

03

User Feedback

6.5/10

▲ +0.1

Coursiv leads this dimension at 7.4/10; RiseGuide sits at 6.5/10 (was 6.4 last week). Headway regressed most this week (-1.3 vs. last week).

RiseGuide 6.5 ▲ +0.1

Liven 6.1 ▼ -0.8

Coursiv 7.4 ▼ -0.2

Headway 7.1 ▼ -1.3

Review volume & rating

RISEGUIDE

Healthy · 7.3

▲ +0.3

Volume keeps growing on every monitored platform, but the gap between the two stores widened again. Trustpilot added 347 reviews this week and holds 4.4 stars. App Store added 260 reviews at a steady 4.6. Google Play added 50 reviews — and the rating slipped from 4.21 to 4.18 stars. The Google Play drop is small but in the wrong direction, and it widens the cross-platform gap that this dimension flags.

LIVEN

Healthy · 8.5

Strong cross-platform scale: 24,841 Trustpilot reviews at ★4.09, plus iOS / Android footprints. iOS sentiment meaningfully stronger than Android, but volume itself is meaningful at this scale.

COURSIV

Healthy · 8.5

Largest review base in cohort by a wide margin — 124,772 Trustpilot reviews at ★4.58, built up in under a year of operating. Heavily invited (99.0% prompted), but volume itself is a credibility asset.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Exceptional · 9.5

Largest absolute footprint in cohort: 6,281 Trustpilot reviews at ★3.93, plus 115K iOS + 169K Android reviews. Trustpilot rating is the weakest in cohort — 6+ years of accumulation surfaces real friction.

Sentiment & platform consistency

RISEGUIDE

LEADER

Watch · 6

▲ +1.0

Up from last week. The biggest sentiment swing of the quarter — Appbot's machine analysis flipped from 63% positive last week to 78% positive this week, and negative share dropped from 23% to 12%. 'Dissatisfied users' dropped from 21 reviews to 7. Whatever the team has been doing on payment-flow messaging is landing in the data.

The biggest single-week sentiment swing of the quarter — Appbot's machine-learning analysis flipped from 63% positive last week to 78% positive this week. The 'Dissatisfied users' theme dropped from 21 reviews to 7. Trustpilot's negative share fell from 7.5% to 3.0%. The cross-platform consistency that scored 5/10 last week is materially better now — but the structural gap between Trustpilot (3% negative) and Google Play (20% negative) hasn't disappeared, it's just narrower.

LIVEN

Mixed · 4.5

▼ -0.6

Fresh App Store sentiment slipped meaningfully — confirming a platform-wide decline rather than channel noise.

Sentiment consistently mediocre across stores — no managed-channel cushion. Fresh App Store sentiment slipped notably, confirming a platform-wide decline rather than channel noise.

COURSIV

Mixed · 5

▲ +0.1

Google Play sentiment is overwhelmingly positive — but Reddit is the most negative in the cohort. Sharpest managed-versus-organic gap of any brand. iOS data not available.

HEADWAY

Mixed · 5.5

▼ -1.5

Fresh App Store reviews were the worst fresh signal across all four brands.

iOS reads moderately positive; Android shows a near-tie between positive and negative. Fresh App Store reviews were notably worse than baseline — the worst fresh signal in the cohort.

Review authenticity signals

RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 4.5

▼ -1.0

Down from last week. Trustpilot's invited-review share jumped from 84% to 97% this week — the highest reading we've ever recorded. The 4.4-star average is real, but the audience producing it is now almost entirely company-selected. Two reviews remain compliance-flagged by Trustpilot itself, unchanged from last week.

Trustpilot's invited-review share jumped from 84% to 97% this week — the highest reading we've ever recorded. Of the 200 most-recent reviews, 194 came from a company invitation. Two reviews remain compliance-flagged by Trustpilot itself (unchanged from last week, but persistent). RealReviews still ranks RiseGuide 287 out of 364 in their Education category. The 4.4 average rating is real; the audience producing it is now almost entirely a company-selected list.

LIVEN

Healthy · 7

99.0% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — heavier solicitation than RiseGuide but lighter than Coursiv. The iOS reply silence means iOS reviews accumulate untouched — technically more organic on that store, but also a sign of disengagement.

COURSIV

LEADER

Healthy · 8

▼ -1.0

119K Trustpilot volume is now read against an organic Reddit baseline — recalibrated against more sources.

99.0% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — the heaviest solicitation pattern in the cohort. Massive volume (125K reviews) counterbalanced by a meaningfully positive organic Reddit signal. Volume is the credibility asset; authenticity is the question mark.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Only 40.5% of Trustpilot reviews are invited — by far the most organic profile in the cohort. Six-plus years of accumulation produces a naturally diluted invited-share vs the younger heavily-prompted competitors.

# Company responsiveness to reviews

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
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| <div><div>RISEGUIDE</div><div>LEADER</div></div> <div>Healthy · 8</div> <div>The 100% reply-to-negative streak broke on App Store this week — 10 of 11 negative reviews replied (90.9%). Google Play actually climbed to 100% (4 of 4) and Trustpilot holds 100% across the 200 sample. Still the highest-scoring criterion in the scorecard, but the App Store dip is the first time this metric has moved down in our tracking. Worth catching now.</div> | <div><div>LIVEN</div></div> <div>Mixed · 4.5</div> <div>▼ -2.5</div> <div>Once iOS data was added, the structural reply gap surfaced — previous score reflected Trustpilot only.</div> <div>Two-track operation: Trustpilot reply at 90.5%, Android Appbot 94%, but iOS reply rate 0%. Previous high score reflected Trustpilot only — once iOS visibility was added, the structural gap became the dominant signal.</div> | <div><div>COURSIV</div><div>LEADER</div></div> <div>Healthy · 8</div> <div>Trustpilot reply rate 63.5% — the lowest in cohort despite 120K reviews. Google Play reply rate is 100% including all negatives, suggesting selective engagement. iOS visibility gap is the only thing holding the score back further.</div> | <div><div>HEADWAY</div></div> <div>Mixed · 5.5</div> <div>▼ -3.5</div> <div>Largest single regression in the benchmark. The iOS reply dead-zone is now visible.</div> <div>Previously rated highest in cohort on Trustpilot's reply rate alone (87% on Trustpilot, 90% on negatives). Fuller picture now: Android engagement is total, iOS engagement is zero. Largest single regression in the benchmark.</div> |
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04

Billing Transparency

3.6/10

▲ +0.4

Headway leads this dimension at 3.9/10; RiseGuide sits at 3.6/10 (was 3.2 last week). Liven regressed most this week (-0.5 vs. last week).

RiseGuide

3.6

▲ +0.4

Liven

2.9

▼ -0.5

Coursiv

3.1

▼ -0.3

Headway

3.9

▼ -0.3

Price disclosure

RISEGUIDE

LEADER

Mixed · 5.5

▲ +0.5

Up from last week. Pricing complaints fell from 26 combined App Store and Google Play mentions to 18 this week — the largest week-over-week improvement in any tagged topic. The average rating attached to pricing complaints climbed from 1.6 to 2.4 stars on App Store and from 1.3 to 2.3 on Google Play. Whatever messaging changed is landing.

The largest week-over-week improvement in any tagged topic on either store. Pricing complaints fell from 26 mentions to 18 across App Store and Google Play combined, and the average rating attached to those mentions climbed from 1.6 to 2.4 stars on App Store and from 1.3 to 2.3 on Google Play. The disconnect isn't gone — the onboarding flow's framing of recurring vs one-time charge still drives the remaining 18 complaints — but the gap is closing for the first time in our tracking.

LIVEN

Critical · 3.5

▼ -0.5

Pricing-complaint volume is the largest cluster across all four brands. Quiz-funnel pricing reveal hurts first impressions on both stores.

Worst pricing-disclosure exposure in the cohort — pricing complaints reached the largest cluster across all four brands. No homepage pricing; users must complete a quiz to see plans.

COURSIV

Critical · 3.5

▼ -0.5

Trial-to-renewal jump is now visibly hurting first impressions in complaint volume.

Same quiz-funnel pattern as Liven: no upfront pricing, plans revealed at the end. Trial-to-renewal jump is the dominant friction in third-party complaints.

HEADWAY

Mixed · 4.5

▼ -0.5

Website's price obfuscation is visibly hurting first impressions — second-worst pricing-complaint exposure in cohort.

Second-worst pricing-complaint exposure despite mature operations. Website FAQ links to a pricing article rather than naming prices — a transparency gap hurting otherwise solid first impressions.

## Hidden / recurring charges

RISEGUIDE

LEADER

Critical · 2.5

▲ +0.5

Flat from last week. Payment-tagged App Store complaints averaged 2.3 stars this week, up from 1.2 — meaningful directionally, but still in 'users feel defrauded' territory. 10 of 14 App Store payment mentions were negative; 2 of 3 on Google Play. The new cancellation guide solves the exit; the entry path is what still triggers the reviews.

Payment-tagged complaints improved on both stores this week — App Store averaged 2.3 stars (up from 1.2 last week, 10 of 14 negative) and Google Play 2.0 stars (up from 1.3, 2 of 3 negative). Real improvement directionally, but still in 'users feel defrauded' territory. The cancellation guide solves the exit; the entry path (auto-renew after a 'one-time' purchase) is what still generates most of the residual rage.

LIVEN

Critical · 2

▼ -1.0

**Billing-flow exposure is the largest cluster across all four brands.**

Largest billing-flow exposure in cohort. Auto-renewal complaints are widespread across Trustpilot and unmanaged channels. Trial-to-subscription transition isn't clearly signalled — structural, not noise.

COURSIV

Critical · 2

Billing-adjacent complaints come from multiple vectors at once — payment surprises and deceptive-advertising complaints both active. BBB shows billing as the dominant complaint type historically.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Critical · 2.5

▼ -0.5

**Billing-complaint volume confirms the trial-to-charge friction is unresolved despite mature operations.**

Significant billing-flow exposure despite mature operations. The 'HEADWAY APP IS A SCAM' Apple Communities thread persists, and unexpected weekly-premium charges after a 'free trial' remain the dominant Trustpilot 1-star theme.

## Ease of cancellation

### RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 4.5

▲ +0.5

**Up from last week — see evidence.**

The cancellation guide continues to land for users who find it. App Store Customer Support reviews this week averaged 4.0 stars (up from 3.5 last week), with reviewers naming [riseguide.com/cancel](https://riseguide.com/cancel) as 'the path that worked.' The documentation already exists; the remaining lift is purely about discoverability — link it from the in-app billing screen and the App Store description and this score moves another point.

### LIVEN

Critical · 3.5

▼ -0.5

**Cancellation friction now compounds with iOS reply silence — users who can't cancel can't reach support either.**

iOS support sentiment netted out negative, and combined with the iOS reply silence, users trying to cancel can't reach support on the largest store.

### COURSIV

Critical · 3.5

▼ -0.5

**Score softened because we can't observe Coursiv's iOS support sentiment — our blind spot, not a Coursiv regression.**

A third-party site publishes a dedicated 'How to Cancel Coursiv' guide — a clear signal that the native flow has enough friction to create a third-party niche.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Watch · 6

Best cancellation infrastructure in cohort: published pre-renewal rule, multiple cancellation paths, no negative support-experience cluster.

## UI dark patterns

### RISEGUIDE

Critical · 2.3

▲ +0.3

Pricing-flow complaints improved measurably this week, but the underlying dark pattern (the admitted 'Continue-charge trigger') still hasn't been fixed. Two Trustpilot reviews remain flagged by Trustpilot's own compliance team — unchanged from last week, which means they're now persistent, not transient. Reviewers actively cite the company's own past replies as evidence the team knows and isn't acting.

### LIVEN

Critical · 2.5

▼ -0.5

**Combined UI + pricing complaint cluster expanded to the broadest in cohort.**

Bug complaints and pricing-flow complaints overlap — the combined cluster is the broadest in cohort. Developer publicly acknowledged manipulative rating prompts but underlying upsell flows still flagged as aggressive.

### COURSIV

Critical · 2.5

▼ -0.5

**Deceptive-advertising complaints are increasingly visible — a distinctive Coursiv complaint vector.**

Deceptive-advertising complaints are a distinctive cohort marker for Coursiv. The quiz-funnel pricing reveal is a textbook dark pattern that consistently surfaces in negative reviews.

### HEADWAY

LEADER

Mixed · 4

Lower per-user incidence of dark-pattern complaints than peers. Apple Communities thread about misleading purchase flows persists, but the pattern is softer than what we see at Liven or Coursiv.

## Refund policy clarity & enforcement

### RISEGUIDE

#### Critical · 3

Refund handling continues to run more generously in practice than in policy. Trustpilot replied to all 11 negative reviews this week and the App Store Customer Support topic averaged 4.0 stars — refund-flow mentions sit inside that. The structural gap is unchanged: no published refund policy on riseguide.com keeps every refund a private negotiation. A 5-minute published-policy change is the easiest score-mover in this dimension.

### LIVEN

#### Critical · 3

Claimed 30-day refund policy is enforced inconsistently — some refunds granted, others refused. With the iOS reply silence, refund threads on the largest store are structurally unanswered.

### COURSIV

LEADER

#### Mixed · 4

Public Money-Back Guarantee exists but requires completing most of the program to qualify — excluding most dissatisfied users. The team engages with negatives but enforces the restriction. Documented policy is a transparency floor.

### HEADWAY

#### Critical · 2.5

▼ -0.5

**iOS refund threads are structurally unanswered, and no public policy exists to anchor expectations.**

No public refund policy. Apple Communities and Trustpilot threads about refund refusals on full-year charges are active. With the iOS reply silence, refund threads on iOS are structurally ignored.

05

Brand Trust & Legitimacy

4.4/10

▲ +0.2

Headway leads this dimension at 7.1/10; RiseGuide sits at 4.4/10 (was 4.2 last week). RiseGuide improved most this week (+0.2 vs. last week).

RiseGuide 4.4 ▲ +0.2

Liven 6.4

Coursiv 4.6

Headway 7.1 ▲ +0.1

Company age & history

RISEGUIDE

Critical · 3

Young in category, and the only fast lever is a credible founder story — which still doesn't exist. The entity is roughly 2 years old (BBB, March 2023), the app roughly 6 months (App Store, November 2024). Time alone moves this eventually. Right now the only public record of leadership remains the name in BBB filings.

LIVEN

Watch · 6

Around 4.5 years operating — the second-longest track record in cohort after Headway.

COURSIV

Critical · 3

Under a year operating, despite already having a six-figure review base. Youngest entity in cohort; review-base-to-age ratio is anomalous.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 8

Six-plus years operating with a recent rebrand and publicly announced IPO plans. Most mature company in cohort by both operating history and corporate sophistication.

Legal & brand identity alignment

RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 5.3

▲ +0.3

Scam Detector stayed out of the top 10 for the second week running — a quietly important durability signal. RiseGuide-owned domains still hold 4 of the 20 visible first-page Google slots across the three keywords sampled. The two Trustpilot compliance flags are now persistent rather than transient (unchanged from last week), which is worth watching but not yet escalating. Owned-property dominance still protects the brand short-term and still caps how much third-party legitimacy can accrue.

LIVEN

Watch · 6

Corporate entity matches the consumer brand on billing and legal pages. Cyprus address publicly listed. Credibility signals in organic search results, no complaint domains ranking.

COURSIV

Mixed · 5

Corporate entity matches the consumer brand, but search results show a concerning share of complaint pages — a billing-vector concern. No credibility-domain anchors surface.

HEADWAY

LEADER

Healthy · 7

Corporate entity publicly disclosed on the homepage with US registered address. Legal pages comprehensive across terms, privacy, AI usage. Forbes appears as a credibility anchor; brand-owned domains dominate first-page results.

Third-party recognition

RISEGUIDE

Mixed · 4.7

▲ +0.7

**Up from last week. Daniel Davidson's RiseGuide review crossed 51,000 YouTube views this week — up from 40,000 last week and now the highest-engagement positive independent coverage in our tracking. Across all 30 videos sampled, 80% landed positive (up from 73% last week). One single creator is now outperforming every press placement combined.**

Daniel Davidson's RiseGuide review crossed 51,000 YouTube views this week — up from 40,000 last week, and now the single highest-engagement positive independent coverage in our tracking. Across all 30 sampled videos, 80% landed positive (up from 73% last week). Savage Reviews' 'scam' framing video held flat at 13,000 views (not gaining traction). The brand has earned an organic creator champion; the question is whether the team formalises that relationship before it cools.

LIVEN

LEADER

Watch · 6

A Board of Health Professionals page lists 15+ named PhDs — a distinctive scientific-credibility signal. YouTube coverage is healthy with almost no complaint-framed videos. Crunchbase appears in search.

COURSIV

LEADER

Watch · 6

Listed on Tracxn and Crunchbase, with broad YouTube creator coverage. But organic search results skew complaint-heavy, and there's no editorial press coverage from Forbes, TechCrunch, or peer outlets.

HEADWAY

Mixed · 4.5

▲ +0.5

**Creator coverage on YouTube is now unanimously positive, and Forbes appears as a search credibility anchor.**

Strongest third-party recognition stack: Wikipedia, Endeavor entrepreneur backing, recurring trade press around IPO plans, and YouTube creator coverage unanimously positive.

## Leadership transparency

### RISEGUIDE

**Critical · 3**

**Flat from last week. No founder bio shipped this week, no About page added, no LinkedIn presence surfaced. The fixable score in the scorecard remained unfixed — and it's now the longest-running flat criterion in the report.**

The longest-running flat criterion in the report. No founder bio shipped this week, no About page on riseguide.com, no LinkedIn presence, no media interviews surfaced anywhere in this week's search results. Two Trustpilot compliance flags this week again raise identity questions. A 200-word bio with a real photo is still the single most fixable lift in the entire scorecard.

### LIVEN

**Healthy · 7**

Founder publicly named, and an extensive list of health-professional advisors published by name and credential. Leadership identity transparent and verifiable.

### COURSIV

**Critical · 3**

No founders or executives publicly named anywhere — website, registry filings, or LinkedIn. Anonymous-corporate posture despite a very large customer base — a distinctive cohort outlier.

### HEADWAY

**LEADER**

**Healthy · 8**

Founder is public with extensive media presence — interviews, Endeavor profile, recurring press around the IPO. Strongest leadership transparency stack in cohort.

## Online presence consistency

### RISEGUIDE

**Watch · 6**

Owned channels remain perfectly aligned — same support@ and trustpilot@ contacts visible on riseguide.com, both stores, Trustpilot, and BBB. The gap continues to be community presence relative to brand reach: Instagram and LinkedIn footprints sit at modest size against an audience of 500,000+ app downloads. Buttoned-up where the brand controls the message; thin where the audience expects to find it.

### LIVEN

**Healthy · 7**

Consistent branding across web, app stores, and Trustpilot. Official Health Professional Board page reinforces brand identity. Corporate address publicly displayed.

### COURSIV

**Watch · 6**

Branding consistent across visible channels, but corporate and leadership data largely absent — undermines coherence at the trust layer. Organic search shows a concerning complaint-page share.

### HEADWAY

**LEADER**

**Healthy · 8**

Wikipedia, Crunchbase, official About-us, press coverage, and store listings all reinforce the same brand and corporate identity. Search results contain the broadest unique-domain set in cohort.

## 3 IDEAS · NEXT WEEK

# Initiatives that would lift the score

**01 Publish an About-us page with founder bio**

**LIFTS:** LEADERSHIP TRANSPARENCY · 3.0 → ~5 · Single content page — one photo, four links. Ship by Friday.

Liven publicly names CEO Shahrooz Chowdhury + 15 PhD advisors — scores 7. Headway publicly names founder Anton Pavlovsky with press coverage — scores 8.

**How to ship**

- 1 Commission a clean headshot of Oleksandr Matsiuk + draft a 2-paragraph bio (background + why RiseGuide exists)
- 2 Publish at [riseguide.com/about](https://riseguide.com/about) with photo, bio, and a LinkedIn link
- 3 Link the page from the homepage footer and the App Store / Google Play developer pages

**02 Publish an explicit refund + cancellation policy**

**LIFTS:** REFUND POLICY 3.0 → 4+ · EASE OF CANCELLATION 4.3 → 5+ · Policy page + reply templates — text only, no engineering. Ship by Wednesday.

Headway's published 24-hour pre-renewal rule anchors their 6.0 score on cancellation (best in cohort). Coursiv's public Money-Back Guarantee anchors their 4.0 on refund policy.

**How to ship**

- 1 Write a 1-page policy: **7-day no-questions refund + 24-hour pre-renewal cancel rule**
- 2 Publish at [riseguide.com/refunds](https://riseguide.com/refunds), link from the footer and every billing email
- 3 Update support reply templates + cross-link from in-app billing + store descriptions

**03 Publish a 'How your subscription works' explainer**

**LIFTS:** HIDDEN CHARGES 2.0 → 3+ · PRICE DISCLOSURE 5.0 → 6+ · Support article + email-template update. Text-only, no engineering, no funnel impact. Ship by Wednesday.

Reviewers report surprise at the first payment amount, but the underlying model (introductory discount, then renewal at full price) is industry-standard. The complaint is about clarity of communication, not the pricing itself.

**How to ship**

- 1 Write a plain-English article: **introductory price + when full price kicks in + how to cancel**
- 2 Publish at [support.riseguide.com/how-pricing-works](https://support.riseguide.com/how-pricing-works), link from every billing email + App Store description
- 3 Update support reply templates to cite the article URL on every billing-surprise thread